

Andrew van der Westhuizen

Product Head | Technology & Digital Banking Leader

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PROFILE

Technology and product leader with 13+ years at Capitec Bank, spanning software development, delivery management and product strategy across banking and telecoms. Track record of building middleware and microservice capabilities, introducing Agile ways of working at enterprise scale, and leading fraud-reduction strategy across digital channels. Currently leading new market entry for Capitec's telecoms division, bringing banking-grade rigor to a high-scale, income-generating product. MBA (Emerging Markets) and BSc Honours in Computer Science, both from the University of Cape Town.

EXPERIENCE

Product Head — Capitec Bank

Nov 2021 – Present · 4 yrs 10 mos | Cape Town, Western Cape, South Africa

- Led strategy to reduce fraud across USSD and Internet Banking, driving USSD to the lowest fraud-per-active-client ratio of any digital channel.
- Managed the rewards product portfolio before moving into the telecoms division to spearhead a new market entry.
- Shifted focus from managing supporting banking channels to building primary, income-generating products at a new order of scale and structural complexity.
- Core skills: Strategic Leadership, Retail Banking, and related product and stakeholder management disciplines.

Development Manager — Capitec Bank

Oct 2016 – Nov 2021 · 5 yrs 2 mos | City of Cape Town, Western Cape, South Africa

- Built the bank's first middleware capabilities, moving away from a legacy two-tier architecture.
- Managed the decoupling of Internet Banking from mobile platforms while maintaining USSD and legacy channels.
- Refactored technical debt from earlier staffing-driven efficiencies, aligning systems with the industry shift toward microservices.
- Core skills: Product Management, Client Communication, and 15+ related delivery and technical disciplines.

Scrum Master: eChannels — Capitec Bank

Mar 2015 – Jan 2017 · 1 yr 11 mos

- Served as the bank's first Scrum Master, leading the pilot team that introduced Agile methodologies to the organization.
- Built reporting frameworks using JIRA that provided the empirical evidence needed to prove Scrum's viability to the business.
- Scaled a self-managed "skunkworks" JIRA instance into the bank's enterprise-wide solution, driving adoption and justifying the investment to leadership.
- Core skills: Delivery Management, HTML5, and 15+ related Agile and technical disciplines.

Analyst Developer — Capitec Bank

Mar 2013 – Mar 2015 · 2 yrs 1 mo | Stellenbosch

- Joined as a Java developer in the mobile space; focus quickly shifted from feature development to the build pipeline.
- Led the migration from Gradle to Maven to remove dependency on Eclipse and strip out custom build complexity.
- Tackled early security and scaling issues while streamlining the development environment for architectural simplicity and operational efficiency.
- Core skills: HTML5, Agile Development, and 10+ related technical disciplines.

Senior Analyst Programmer — University of Stellenbosch

Oct 2011 – Mar 2013 · 1 yr 6 mos | Stellenbosch

- Overall Java technical lead.
- Development lead for the replacement of the university portal.
- Business analyst for the newly developed parking system.
- Systems analyst for the integration with the chosen Learning Management System (LMS).
- Core skills: Skill Development, Problem Solving, and 5+ related technical disciplines.

Senior Systems Analyst — University of Stellenbosch

Jan 2010 – Oct 2011 · 1 yr 10 mos | Somerset West, Western Cape, South Africa

- Focused on innovative solutions to technical challenges outside normal business activities, including SSO between different operating systems, proxy caching of sensitive Oracle Portal pages, and enabling new developer libraries on older systems.
- Core skills: Client Communication, Problem Solving, and 5+ related technical disciplines.

Senior Developer — eSight CC

Mar 2007 – Feb 2010 · 3 yrs | City of Cape Town, Western Cape, South Africa

- Consulted for various Oracle-based companies in the Western Cape, including proofs of concept, Oracle middleware training, and development projects.
- Led the most significant development project: the rebranding of MortgageSA to Ooba.
- Core skills: Client Communication, Delivery Management, and 4+ related technical disciplines.

Tutor — Master Maths

Jan 2003 – Dec 2004 · 2 yrs | Somerset West, Western Cape, South Africa

- Tutored mathematics to grade ten, eleven and twelve higher-grade students.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (MBA), Emerging Markets

University of Cape Town | 2011 – 2012

Activities and societies: Mountain and ski club.

Coursework included extensive group work and a full strategy analysis of a Grabouw-region farm with a net turnover of R99,000,000 for 2011.

Thesis: "Exploring the Barriers to Retiring Enterprise Software" — examined the challenges expected when retiring an ERP solution such as SAP or Oracle.

Bachelor of Science Honours (BSc Hons), Computer Science

University of Cape Town | 2006

Activities and societies: Mountain and ski club.

Coursework spanned advanced computer graphics, network and internetwork security, and J2EE and distributed computing.

Thesis: "Fixing Large Point Sets" — upsampling and downsampling of point cloud data sets.

Bachelor of Science (BSc), Computer Science

University of Cape Town | 2002 – 2005

Activities and societies: Mountain and ski club.

Undergraduate degree in Computer Science; developed software for external companies on behalf of the department.